

John Felix Raj is a professor of economics at St. Xavier's University, Kolkata (SXUK), India. He is a Jesuit priest of the Calcutta province of the Society of Jesus. He was the Rector from 1996 to 2002 and Principal from 2009 to 2017 of St. Xavier's College, Kolkata.

Early life

Raj was born on 26 August 1954 in Poolangudi, Ramanathapuram district, Tamil Nadu. He completed his school education at St. Michael's School, Sengudi and at St. Mary's High School, Thoothukudi.

Education

He joined the Jesuit Order in 1974 at the age of 20. He graduated from Loyola College, Chennai in 1980 in Economics and acquired a master's degree from St Joseph's College, Tiruchirappalli. He underwent his Jesuit training of philosophy in Pune at JDV and theology at Delhi Vidyajothi Institute respectively. He was ordained priest on 23 April 1989. He completed his Ph.D. in economics in Rabindra Bharati University, Kolkata.

Career

Since 1996, Raj is the Director and Secretary of the Goethals Indian Library and Research Society in Kolkata.

Raj opened a rural campus at Raghobpur for St. Xavier's College, Kolkata in 2014. Raj took over as the first Vice-Chancellor of St. Xavier's University, Kolkata (SXUK) from 16 February 2017.

Raj was named Banga Bibhushan in 2014 by the West Bengal government.

In 2021, during Raj's vice-chancellorship at SXUK, an assistant professor resigned and alleged that she was forced to do by Raj and other administrators. According to a police complaint she filed, Raj called her into a meeting, told her that a family had complained about swimsuit photos of her that she had posted on social media, and threatened to fire her if she did not

resign. The university claimed the resignation was voluntary and sent the former employee a defamation letter seeking ₹99 crore in damages. An online petition calling for disciplinary action against Raj received over 21,700 signatures by August 2022. In July 2023, the Supreme Court of India refused to hear the case.

Selected bibliography

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